

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 4: TO AUTUMN (BY JOHN KEATS)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"To Autumn" is a magnificent nature ode composed by John Keats. The poem beautifully describes the abundant maturity, harvest, and serene beauty of the autumn season. Keats portrays autumn as a close friend of the sun, filling nature with ripe fruits, golden landscapes, and its own unique musical sounds.

 12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. How are autumn and the sun related to each other in the poem?

Ans: Autumn and the sun are described as close, conspiring bosom-friends. Together, they plan how to load and bless the vines and trees with an abundance of ripe fruit.

Q2. What happens to the fruits and plants during the autumn season?

Ans: During autumn, all fruits ripen completely to the core. Gourd swells, hazel shells get plump with a sweet kernel, and flowers bud late for the bees.

Q3. How is autumn personified as a woman on the granary floor?

Ans: Autumn is personified as a woman sitting carelessly on a granary floor, with her hair gently lifted and blowing in the soft, winnowing wind.

Q4. Where can autumn be found sleeping, and why?

Ans: Autumn can be found sound asleep on a half-reaped furrow or field, intoxicated by the sweet, soothing smell of poppy flowers.

Q5. What does autumn do with a cider-press?

Ans: Autumn watches the last oozings or drops of apple juice squeezing out of a cider-press patiently, hour by hour, symbolizing the slow end of the harvest.

Q6. What does the poet mean by the question, "Where are the songs of Spring?"

Ans: The poet asks this to remind the readers not to compare autumn with spring. He tells autumn that it has its own unique, beautiful music and music notes.



CLASS - 12th **SUBJECT - ENGLISH** **PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH**

Q7. What kind of music or sounds does autumn make in the evening?

Ans: In the evening, autumn's music includes the wailing of gnats, the bleating of full-grown lambs, the singing of hedge-cricket, and the whistling of red-breasts.

Q8. How does the sky look during an autumn sunset?

Ans: The sky looks calm and soft as barred clouds bloom and glow over the stubble-plains, tinting the landscape with a warm, rosy hue.

Q9. Why do the bees think that the warm days will never cease?

Ans: The bees think so because autumn continues to provide late summer flowers, causing their sticky, honeyed cells to overflow with sweet honey.

Q10. Who was John Keats, and what type of poet was he?

Ans: John Keats was a great English poet belonging to the Romantic era. He was deeply famous for his intense love for nature, sensory imagery, and odes.

Q11. What does the phrase "matured sun" imply in the text?

Ans: It implies the sun in its full, warm power during the harvest season, working together with autumn to bring life and maturity to nature.

Q12. What is the central message or theme of "To Autumn"?

Ans: The central theme is the celebration of nature's cycle of maturity and fulfillment, showing that every phase of nature possesses its own unique beauty and glory.

© 35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'To Autumn' is a well-known nature ode composed by: (A) John Donne (B) John Keats (C) W.H. Auden (D) Rupert Brooke
2. John Keats belongs to the celebrated group of _____ poets.: (A) Metaphysical (B) Romantic (C) War (D) Modern
3. John Keats was born in London in 1795 and died at a very young age in: (A) 1821 (B) 1850 (C) 1900 (D) 1915
4. Keats tragically died of which fatal disease at the age of twenty-six?: (A) Malaria (B) Tuberculosis (C) Cancer (D) Cholera
5. Important works of John Keats include 'Endymion', 'Hyperion', and: (A) Leaves of Grass (B) Ode on a Grecian Urn (C) Songs and Sonnets (D) The Earth
6. "To Autumn" is structurally categorized as a/an: (A) Lyric (B) Sonnet (C) Ode (D) Elegy
7. Autumn is described as the close bosom-friend of the maturing _____. ∴ (A) moon (B) sun (C) rain (D) wind



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

8. Autumn and the sun conspire together to load and bless vines with _____. ∴ (A) flowers (B) fruit (C) snow (D) leaves
9. "To swell the gourd, and plump the hazel _____.": (A) trees (B) shells (C) leaves (D) grass
10. The late summer flowers make the bees believe that warm days will _____. ∴ (A) end quickly (B) never cease (C) come late (D) be cold
11. The honeybees' cells are described in the first stanza as completely: (A) empty (B) clammy / overflowing (C) dry (D) broken
12. "Who hath not seen thee oft amid thy _____.?": (A) store (B) garden (C) forest (D) river
13. Anyone searching for autumn can find her sitting carelessly on a _____ floor.: (A) kitchen (B) granary (C) palace (D) school
14. Autumn's hair is described as being gently lifted by the winnowing _____. ∴ (A) water (B) wind (C) hand (D) feather
15. Autumn is sometimes found fast asleep on a half-reaped _____. ∴ (A) bed (B) furrow / field (C) mountain (D) house
16. Autumn falls asleep because she is intoxicated by the perfume of _____. ∴ (A) roses (B) poppies (C) lilies (D) sunflowers
17. While autumn sleeps, her hook spares the next swath and all its twined _____. ∴ (A) fruits (B) flowers (C) branches (D) leaves
18. Autumn acts like a gleaner, keeping steady her laden head across a _____. ∴ (A) river (B) brook / stream (C) road (D) mountain
19. Autumn watches the last oozeings of apple juice hour by hour at a _____. ∴ (A) mill (B) cider-press (C) market (D) farm
20. "Where are the songs of _____. ? Ay, think not of them...": (A) Summer (B) Spring (C) Winter (D) Monsoon
21. The poet consoles autumn by stating that she has her own unique _____. ∴ (A) wealth (B) music (C) clothes (D) dynamic
22. During sunset, the barred clouds bloom and give a rosy glow to the _____ plains.: (A) green (B) stubble / harvested (C) muddy (D) snowy
23. In the twilight, the small gnats make a mournful wailing choir among the _____. ∴ (A) trees (B) willows / salallows (C) mountains (D) houses
24. Full-grown _____ loud bleat from the hilly bourn.: (A) cows (B) lambs (C) goats (D) lions
25. "And hedge-cricket _____ ; and now with treble soft...": (A) bark (B) sing (C) sleep (D) fly
26. The bird that whistles with a soft treble note from a garden-croft is the _____. ∴ (A) sparrow (B) red-breast / robin (C) peacock (D) cuckoo
27. At the very end of the poem, the gathering swallows tweet and twitter in the _____. ∴ (A) trees (B) skies (C) nests (D) water



CLASS - 12th SUBJECT - ENGLISH PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

28. The poem beautifully depicts three stages of autumn: maturity, harvest, and _____. : (A) onset of spring (B) arrival of winter / sunset (C) heavy rain (D) summer heat
29. John Keats was deeply interested in Greek culture, a trait known as _____. : (A) Socialism (B) Hellenism (C) Romanticism (D) Modernism
30. The tone of the poem "To Autumn" is highly serene, calm, and _____. : (A) angry (B) meditative / appreciative (C) sorrowful (D) funny
31. The term 'Gleaner' in the second stanza refers to a person who collects leftover _____. : (A) money (B) grain / corn (C) stones (D) wood
32. Each stanza of the ode 'To Autumn' consists of exactly _____ lines.: (A) ten (B) eleven (C) fourteen (D) eight
33. The sensory description used by Keats makes the reader almost _____ the fruits.: (A) fear (B) taste and feel (C) hate (D) buy
34. "To Autumn" was written in the year 1819, representing Keats's finest period of _____. : (A) childhood (B) poetic maturity (C) medical study (D) travels
35. The poem presents nature as an independent entity filled with beauty and _____. : (A) chaos (B) harmony (C) political data (D) tools

SUJIT KUMAR

